people are aware about it?
Well, vascular surgery plays a crucial role in improving the quality of life and saving lives of individuals with vascular disorders by restoring proper blood flow and preventing complications such as limb loss, stroke, and organ damage.

Vascular surgery is a specialized medical field that focuses on treating conditions affecting the blood vessels, including the arteries, veins, and lymphatic system. Vascular surgeons are trained to diagnose, manage, and surgically treat a wide range of vascular disorders, from relatively common conditions such as varicose veins and peripheral artery disease (PAD) to complex issues like aortic aneurysms and vascular trauma.

The circulatory system is crucial for delivering oxygen and nutrients to tissues and organs throughout the body. When blood vessels become diseased or damaged, it can impair blood flow and lead to serious health complications. Vascular surgery aims to restore proper blood circulation and prevent potentially life-threatening consequences.

- **What type of modalities are prevalent in this surgical stream?**

Vascular surgeons utilize a variety of treatment modalities, including both traditional open surgery and minimally invasive techniques. For instance, Angioplasty and Stenting is minimally invasive procedure involves threading a catheter through the blood vessels to the site of blockage or narrowing. A balloon is then inflated to widen the vessel, and a stent (a small mesh tube) may be inserted to help keep the vessel open. Likewise Bypass Surgery is used in cases where blood flow is severely restricted or blocked, vascular surgeons may create a bypass using a graft (a synthetic or natural vessel) to reroute blood flow around the diseased or blocked segment of the artery.

Then there are vein procedures Vascular surgeons also treat for venous disorders, such as varicose veins and deep vein thrombosis (DVT), through procedures like vein stripping, sclerotherapy, and endogenous ablation. Vascular surgeons are skilled in repairing or replacing weakened or bulging sections of blood vessels, known as aneurysms, to prevent rupture and life-threatening bleeding.

- **What has led to Surge in Prominence vascular surgery?**

Several factors contribute to the burgeoning prominence of vascular surgery. The advent of minimally invasive techniques, such as endovascular procedures and robotic-assisted surgeries, has revolutionized the field. These approaches offer reduced recovery times, fewer complications, and enhanced precision, making them particularly appealing for diabetic patients who often face challenges with wound healing and infection. Besides Ageing Population and Chronic Diseases is yet

another cause for its surge. With the global population aging and the prevalence of chronic conditions like diabetes soaring, the demand for vascular interventions is escalating. Diabetic individuals are especially susceptible to vascular complications such as peripheral artery disease (PAD), diabetic foot ulcers, and critical limb ischemia, necessitating prompt intervention to prevent amputations and improve quality of life.

- **What is the role of Vascular Surgery in Diabetic Care and how it can help in saving lives and prevent amputations etc?**

For diabetic patients, vascular surgery plays a pivotal role in mitigating the deleterious effects of vascular complications. These individuals are prone to microvascular and macrovascular diseases, which can lead to devastating consequences if left untreated. Vascular surgeons are adept at addressing a myriad of issues, including Peripheral Artery Disease (PAD). Diabetics frequently develop PAD, characterized by narrowed arteries in the legs, leading to reduced blood flow and potential tissue damage. Vascular surgeons employ techniques like angioplasty, stenting, and bypass grafting to restore blood flow and alleviate symptoms such as leg pain and non-healing wounds.

Then it is great help in treating Diabetic Foot Complications. Foot ulcers and infections are common complications of diabetes, often culminating in limb-threatening conditions. Vascular assessment and timely interventions, including debridement, revascularization, and wound care, are paramount in salvaging limbs and preventing amputations.

It is also very effective in Aneurysm Management. Diabetic patients with atherosclerosis are at an increased risk of developing arterial aneurysms, particularly in the aorta. Vascular surgeons excel in diagnosing and managing these potentially life-threatening conditions, employing techniques such as endovascular aneurysm repair (EVAR) to prevent rupture and catastrophic bleeding.

It is a great help in Renal and Mesenteric Artery Disease. Diabetes can affect blood flow to vital organs such as the kidneys and intestines, leading to renal artery stenosis and mesenteric ischemia. Vascular interventions, including angioplasty and stenting, help restore perfusion to these organs, preserving renal function and preventing intestinal infarction.



- **How is the Growth of Vascular Surgery in the Country?**

In many countries, including India the field of vascular surgery is experiencing rapid growth and expansion. Healthcare institutions like Sir Ganga Ram Hospital are investing in state-of-the-art equipment and facilities to support advanced vascular interventions, attracting top talent and fostering innovation.

Besides, recognizing the importance of vascular health, governments are allocating resources towards vascular surgery research, education, and infrastructure development, enhancing access to specialized care for all segments of the population.

- **How do you see the scope of Vascular surgery in the country in the years to come**

In an era marked by escalating rates of diabetes and vascular disease, the field of vascular surgery emerges as a beacon of hope, offering lifesaving/limbsaving interventions and restoring mobility and vitality to countless individuals. Through technological innovation, interdisciplinary collaboration, and a steadfast commitment to patient care, vascular surgeons are at the forefront of combating the ravages of vascular complications in diabetic patients. As the field continues to evolve and expand, its impact on improving patient outcomes and saving lives is destined to grow exponentially. Though the true potential of Vascular surgery is yet to be realised but it is already saving lives and limbs.